CHAPTER 4

INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Analyze the imperative of global governance, the institutional evolution of the United Nations, proposals for UN Security Council restructuring, functions of key specialized agencies including UNESCO, UNICEF, and WHO, and the global roles of the Bretton Woods bodies and the WTO.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Imperative of Multilateral Institutions:** International bodies facilitate interstate cooperation to manage global public goods, mitigate environmental disasters, contain pandemics, and mediate disputes to prevent military escalation.

• **Structure of the United Nations:** Established on 24 October 1945 as successor to the League of Nations, the UN operates through its General Assembly, Security Council, Economic and Social Council, Secretariat, and International Court of Justice.

• **Security Council Reform Dilemma:** Features five permanent veto-wielding powers (P5: US, UK, France, Russia, China) and ten two-year term non-permanent members, facing reform pressures based on Kofi Annan's 1997 criteria reflecting contemporary global realities.

• **Specialized and Multilateral Agencies:** Encompasses functional agencies including UNESCO (education and cultural heritage), UNICEF (children's welfare and rights), WHO (public health coordination), and multilateral financial bodies like the IMF, World Bank, and WTO.

ESSENTIAL CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLES & THEORIES

$$\text{UN Security Council Structure} \iff \text{P5 Permanent (Veto Power)} + 10 \text{ Non-Permanent (Two-Year Terms)}$$

Executive Architecture of the Primary UN Security Organ

$$\text{Kofi Annan UNSC Criteria (1997)} \iff \{\text{Economic Size}, \quad \text{Military Weight}, \quad \text{Democracy}, \quad \text{UN Budget Share}\}$$

Proposed Benchmarks for New Permanent Security Council Seats

$$\text{Bretton Woods Institutions} \iff \{\text{World Bank (Development Loans)}, \quad \text{IMF (Balance of Payments Support)}\}$$

Twin Pillars of Post-War Multilateral Financial Governance

$$\text{Multilateral Trade Evolution} \iff \text{GATT (1947)} \longrightarrow \text{Marrakesh Agreement} \longrightarrow \text{WTO (1 January 1995)}$$

Transition from Provisional Agreement to Rule-Based Trade Body

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Remember that non-permanent members of the Security Council serve two-year terms and cannot be immediately re-elected upon expiration of their term.

• **Alert:** Do not confuse the International Monetary Fund (macroeconomic stability and balance of payments rescue) with the World Bank (long-term infrastructure and development loans).

• **Alert:** Be careful with the founding date of the UN: the Charter was signed on 26 June 1945 at San Francisco and came into legal effect on 24 October 1945 (United Nations Day).

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. State two fundamental reasons why international organisations like the United Nations are essential in contemporary world politics. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Facilitating Global Cooperation:** They provide a legitimate platform to negotiate solutions for challenges that no single nation can solve alone, such as climate change, pandemics, and terrorism. **[1 Mark]**

• **Conflict Prevention and Peacekeeping:** They facilitate diplomatic mediation and deploy international peacekeeping forces to prevent regional disputes from escalating into full-scale war. **[1 Mark]**

2. Name the five permanent members of the UN Security Council and explain what is meant by the 'Veto power'. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Five Permanent Members:** The United States, the United Kingdom, France, Russia, and China. **[1 Mark]**

• **Meaning of Veto Power:** The constitutional right of any single permanent member to cast a negative vote that completely blocks any substantive resolution, regardless of overwhelming majority support. **[1 Mark]**

3. Highlight the major criteria proposed by UN Secretary-General Kofi Annan in 1997 for inducting new permanent members into the UN Security Council. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Economic and Military Power:** A candidate country should be a major economic power and maintain significant military capability. **[1 Mark]**

• **Financial Contribution and Population:** A substantial contributor to the UN regular budget and a country with a large population base. **[1 Mark]**

• **Democratic Credentials and Diversity:** A nation that respects democracy and human rights, whose inclusion makes the Security Council representative of world cultural and geographic diversity. **[1 Mark]**

4. Explain the distinct mandates and activities of UNESCO and UNICEF as specialized agencies of the United Nations. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **UNESCO Mandate:** Dedicated to promoting international collaboration through education, natural and social sciences, culture, communication, and preserving World Heritage sites. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **UNICEF Mandate:** Focuses on providing emergency food, healthcare, basic education, clean water, and defending the fundamental human rights of children in vulnerable communities. **[1.5 Marks]**

5. Discuss the primary arguments supporting India's claim for a permanent seat in a restructured UN Security Council. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Demographic Prominence:** India represents over one-sixth of global humanity, making its inclusion essential for authentic democratic representation in the council. **[1 Mark]**

• **Democratic Credentials:** India is the world's largest stable constitutional democracy with deep adherence to the rule of law and human rights. **[1 Mark]**

• **Exemplary Peacekeeping Record:** India has historically been one of the largest troop contributors to UN peacekeeping missions worldwide, upholding peace under the UN flag. **[1 Mark]**

• **Economic Resurgence and Financial Reliability:** India's rapidly growing economic scale and consistent payment of assessed UN financial dues strengthen its global governance role. **[1 Mark]**

6. Distinguish between the structural functions of the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund (IMF). [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **World Bank Primary Role:** Provides long-term development loans, technical assistance, and grants primarily to developing nations for infrastructure, education, health, and poverty reduction. **[1.5 Marks]**

• **IMF Primary Role:** Oversees the international monetary system, provides short-term emergency financial assistance to countries facing acute balance of payments crises, and monitors exchange rates. **[1.5 Marks]**

7. Examine the role of the World Trade Organization (WTO) and state two common criticisms directed against its operational policies. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Mandate:** Established on 1 January 1995 as the successor to GATT, the WTO is a permanent international body that sets rules for global trade and settles commercial disputes between nations. **[1 Mark]**

• **Dominance by Powerful Economies:** Critics argue that the decision making process is dominated by developed nations, who compel developing countries to open markets while protecting their own farm sectors. **[1 Mark]**

• **Lack of Transparency:** The negotiation procedures often feature non-inclusive closed-door meetings that compromise the developmental priorities of the Global South. **[1 Mark]**